

invites developers and educators to create their own courses and offer it for sale, usually taking a cut from the fees paid by the student. Depending on whether the student who signed up was initiated by the course creator or by clicking on a paid ad for Udemy, Educators can keep anywhere between 100% or 0% of the course fees.

Courses in Udemy are far more varied in nature, and don't necessarily structure themselves along the lines of a traditional university course. Courses may be specific to a specific skill, for e.g. taking better photographs or building an audience for your blog. These courses are typically shorter in length (Udemy mandates that all courses must be at least 30 minutes long), compared to full-length courses which typically span a couple of months. The structure of these courses is similar to Coursera - the course is split into sections with each section have a short quiz at the end of it. The learning isn't nearly as hands-on as Udacity, though, and student-teacher interaction is almost non-existent. Forums allow students to discuss their problems and ideas, but in our experience these aren't nearly as rich as the ones over at Coursera.

While the quality of the courses on this site is anything but consistent, we've found that Udemy is great if you're looking to acquire a specific skill or fill a gap in your learning. Shorter courses aimed at niche learners tend to be useful, and more often than not, are free of cost. Yahoo CEO Marissa Mayer even teaches a course on Product Development, and while it won't make up for a regular MBA course, is a fine way to bring yourself up to scratch on the fundamentals of managing people and products.

Notable Courses: Learn Web Development from Scratch, How To Sell Your Photographs Online, Sleep Hacking.

4 edX (<http://dgit.in/FTedXorg>) While most online course providers tend to be for-profit companies, edX is an amalgamation of top universities like MIT and Harvard, trying to create an open source web platform for offering free education to the masses. The first course offered was MIT's immensely popular Circuits and Electronics course taught by Anant Agarwal, a professor at MIT and now the CEO of edX, and soon the site expanded into diverse areas such as Cooking, Water Treatment, Solar Energy, Sociology and Literature. The platform on which edX is built is called Open edX, and was Open Sourced with help from Stanford and Google last year.

Courses offered by edX are of an exceptionally high quality, and mimic the experience of taking an actual University course very closely. There